Carmen COUCH-JOHNSON

Full Name	Carmen Couch
Married Name, if different from above	Carmen Johnson
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Do you have a favorite teacher that made an impact on your life, and how? (Limit to 100 words)

Mr Dobbins saw my raw talent and encouraged me to explore. I'm grateful. His classroom was a place where I could be me.

Give us a brief history of your life since graduating: (Limit to 300 words)

Mine was a multi lingual, multi cultural home. I left Willowbrook to attend college and met my husband there. I also became a certified interpreter . Mike and I married in 1981 after graduation and moved to Michigan. We have four children, two boys and two girls. I continued freelance interpreting and found a full time position with AT&T. After acquiring my MBA and MSU Political Fellowship I went on to become an AT&T lobbyist. I left AT&T and became an advocate for the Michigan Deaf community.

Mike and I are now retired although I continue working as an interpreter. We are "snowbirds" with homes in Michigan and Florida. We have six grandchildren.

Tell us about your career path: (Limit to 100 words)

Long story… ASL translator, AT&T manager, AT&T lobbyist, mom, grandma, Deaf Advocate, Director of Resident Services at Life Challenge Addiction Recovery Center (Teen Challenge USA)

What is your proudest achievement: (Limit to 100 words)

My proudest achievement is my family. I am so proud of all four of my children. They each took their own path but are highly successful: bank vice president, chef, engineer, and doctor.

Have you retired? What are you doing now:(Limit to 100 words)

Yes we are retired but I continue to do freelance interpreting. Mike and I enjoy biking and walking and spoiling our grandchildren.